

MUMBAI TRAIN BLASTS

Rescue workers search for bodies inside the mangled compartment of a blast affected local train at Mahim station, Mumbai, Jul. 2006

AFP



◀ *Top to bottom: Jul. 23, 2007, May 26, 2008, Oct. 13, 2008, Dec. 15, 2008*

Declare War on Terror
Dec. 15, 2008

▼

"At 6.30 p.m. on December 3, a week after the terror attacks, two bags containing 8 kg of potently explosive RDX were found on platform number 15 at the crowded Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus (CST) in Mumbai....You would imagine that following the attack at CST, the police would have mopped the place for any evidence, sniffer dogs must have been deployed and the luggage sanitised. Yet a week later, the explosive was sitting at CST awaiting discovery.... It is this casualness, the lack of capacity to comprehend and act, that allowed terrorists to plan and execute what is now being called India's 9/11...."

The defining rupture came on November 26, 2008. The 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks marked a qualitative shift in India's terror experience. Ten heavily armed Pakistan-based militants arrived by sea and laid siege to the city for nearly 60 hours. They attacked luxury hotels, a railway terminus, a café and a Jewish centre, killing 166 people and injuring around 300, and holding India's financial capital hostage in full view of global television cameras. Terror was no longer an intermittent disruption. It had become a strategic challenge.

Running parallel to cross-border terror was another, quieter but deadlier war. Left-wing extremism spread steadily across the Red Corridor. By 2009, Maoist violence affected over 220 districts across 20 states. Thousands of civilians, policemen and security personnel were killed in ambushes, landmine blasts and targeted as-